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Task 9

Ransomware Awareness

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Objective

To identify security measures that help prevent ransomware attacks and protect important data.

Ransomware Prevention Checklist

1. Backup and Recovery

- ☐ Back up important files regularly.
- ☐ Keep at least one backup offline or separate from the main network.
- ☐ Test backups to ensure that files can be restored.

2. Software Updates

- ☐ Update the operating system regularly.
- ☐ Install security updates for applications and browsers.
- ☐ Remove outdated or unnecessary software.

3. Account Security

- ☐ Use strong and unique passwords.
- ☐ Enable Multi-Factor Authentication (MFA).

- ☐ Apply the principle of least privilege.
- ☐ Avoid sharing passwords with others.

4. Email and Internet Safety

- ☐ Do not open suspicious email attachments.
- ☐ Avoid clicking unknown or suspicious links.
- ☐ Download files only from trusted sources.
- ☐ Verify unexpected messages requesting sensitive information.

5. Device Protection

- ☐ Keep antivirus or endpoint protection updated.
- ☐ Enable the firewall.
- ☐ Disable unnecessary services and remote access.
- ☐ Monitor unusual login activity and unexpected file changes.

6. Incident Response

- ☐ Report suspected ransomware immediately.
- ☐ Disconnect an affected device from the network if safe to do so.
- ☐ Avoid connecting backup drives to an infected device.
- ☐ Follow the organisation's incident response and recovery plan.

Conclusion

Ransomware attacks can cause data loss and financial damage. Regular backups, software updates, MFA, strong passwords, and least privilege help reduce these risks. Following this checklist improves cybersecurity awareness and helps protect important information.

Interview Questions

1. What is ransomware?

Answer: Ransomware is a type of malware that locks a computer or encrypts files and demands money to restore access.

Example: An attacker locks your files and asks you to pay money to unlock them.

2. Why are backups important?

Answer: Backups are important because they help us recover lost or encrypted files after a ransomware attack.

Example: If ransomware encrypts our computer files, we can restore them from a safe backup.

3. What is least privilege?

Answer: Least privilege means giving a user only the minimum permissions needed to perform their work.

Example: A student can view study materials but cannot change the college's administrative records.